

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 892

By Walley

A RESOLUTION to honor the United States men's hockey team on winning the gold medal at the 2026 Olympic Games on an overtime goal by Jack Hughes.

WHEREAS, the United States men's hockey team has brought great pride and joy to Americans from all walks of life by emerging victorious from the 2026 Olympic Games as gold medalists and world champions; and

WHEREAS, Team USA defeated archrival Canada in overtime in the final match to claim our nation's third gold medal in men's hockey, exactly forty-six years after 1980's "Miracle on Ice" by America's last men's gold-medal team in the sport; and

WHEREAS, the 2026 Milan Cortina Games mark the first time that the U.S. has won gold in men's hockey at an Olympics in which NHL players were competing; and

WHEREAS, the U.S. squad was unbeaten heading into the gold medal tilt, having outscored its opponents 24-8 in winning five consecutive games; and

WHEREAS, the U.S. men's hockey team steamrolled Latvia, Denmark, and Germany in the preliminary matches of the tournament to advance to the first knockout round; and

WHEREAS, in their quarterfinal game, the Stars and Stripes faced off against an excellent Sweden squad and took an early lead on a goal by Dylan Larkin; and

WHEREAS, after Sweden tied the game late in the third period, Quinn Hughes delivered the golden goal at 3:27 of overtime to propel the U.S. team to victory; he also led the U.S. in total points for the Games with eight and was named the tournament's Best Defender; and

WHEREAS, Team USA then routed Slovakia 6-2 in the semifinals to earn a berth in the gold medal match, in which Matt Boldy scored a beautiful goal early in the first period to give the Americans the lead; however, the Canadians countered with an equalizer late in the second period; and

WHEREAS, after a scoreless third period, the gold medal match entered sudden-decision overtime; just like Superman, Team USA's Jack Hughes then saved the day, finding the back of the net at 1:41 to earn his team the 2-1 victory, the Olympic gold medal, and the title of world champions; and

WHEREAS, to add to this already storybook ending: Jack Hughes was the victim of a high-sticking double-minor penalty by Canada late in regulation; bleeding from the mouth and missing several teeth, he displayed his inner fortitude by returning to the ice and scoring the golden goal in overtime; and

WHEREAS, even though he is now recognized as the ultimate hero of the U.S. team, Jack Hughes would be the first to acknowledge that Connor Hellebuyck, who was named the tournament's Best Goaltender, was the deciding factor in the final match, as he put on a highlight-reel performance in goal that has already become legendary in hockey history; and

WHEREAS, the brotherhood of Team USA was on full display after their historic victory; the U.S. players celebrated on the ice with their late teammate Johnny Gaudreau's jersey, as his family looked on from the crowd in Milan; and

WHEREAS, in fact, Johnny Gaudreau's jersey was hung in the American locker room throughout the tournament as a tribute to this outstanding hockey player and human being, who tragically lost his life in 2024 at the age of thirty-one; and

WHEREAS, in addition to the aforementioned athletes, each of the other U.S. men's hockey players contributed significantly to the success of the team, including Jeremy Swayman, Jake Oettinger, Jack Eichel, alternate captain Charlie McAvoy, captain Auston Matthews, alternate captain Matthew Tkachuk, Brock Nelson, Brady Tkachuk, Zach Werenski, J.T. Miller, Kyle Connor, Jackson LaCombe, Noah Hanifin, Tage Thompson, Jaccob Slavin, Jake Sanderson, Jake Guentzel, Brock Faber, Vincent Trocheck, and Clayton Keller; and

WHEREAS, Team USA enjoyed outstanding leadership in the front office and on the bench, in the persons of head coach Mike Sullivan and general manager Bill Guerin; and

WHEREAS, we find it appropriate to acknowledge and applaud Team USA for winning the Olympic gold medal in men's hockey while representing their country with patriotism and passion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate the players, coaches, and staff members of the United States men's hockey team on winning the gold medal at the 2026 Olympic Games, praising their performance on the ice as world champions and extending to them our best wishes for much continued success in their future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we honor and recognize Jack Hughes for his resiliency in returning to the ice after suffering a major injury to score the winning goal in overtime of the gold medal match, thus earning the eternal gratitude of a nation.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.